

SPECIAL NOTICE DARPA-SN-26-68

Advanced Energetics Manufacturing Technical Interchange Meeting

EVENT DATE: May 27, 2026, in Arlington, VA

RESPONSE EVENT: Until 11:59 PM Eastern Time (ET) on May 8, 2026

TECHNICAL POC: Dr. Hunter Martin, STO Program Manager

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BACKGROUND:

Energetics in the U.S. are produced almost exclusively using batch processing in large mixers with highly concentrated, pure input materials due to the susceptibility to impurities from the large reaction volume and limited control. Furthermore, these are fixed systems designed to only produce one class of product and require a large footprint (acres) of secondary processing to safely handle in batches. These legacy approaches are hindered by cost, size, and technical expertise required to operate and maintain multiple, different dedicated energetics processing reactors for both explosive and propellant needs.

REQUESTED INFORMATION:

DARPA is interested in learning about new technologies that can enable increased efficiency in production and distribution of energetic materials. To bound this problem, this RFI will focus on reactor platforms and software for the high-rate/throughput of crystalline energetics production, from a throughput and/or rate perspective. Crystalline energetics are of interest (e.g., RDX, HMX, etc.), including traditional chemistries as well as non-traditional chemistries that may not fit into current insensitive munitions or shelf-life requirements. Additionally, supply chain resiliency (e.g. incoming raw materials, cost, etc.) to produce energetics is also of interest.

Technical Topic Areas:

- State-of-the-art energetics processing approaches, including but not limited to continuous flow technology, continuous crystallization, wastewater remediation, rapid energetic drying, water/solvent recycling, etc.
- Energetics reaction planning/prediction tools
- In-line process monitoring tools for energetics production
- Footprint reduction via process intensification
- Resource Resiliency/Reduction: raw material supply chains, cost, personnel (maintenance & staffing)
- Industrialization and scale-up of current or innovative energetic material processing techniques

Core Content Requirements:

- Identify key insights, tractable solutions, and accelerated path to burn-down risks
- Quantify impact and sufficiency of solutions to meet growing national security concerns

SUBMISSION FORMAT

Respondents to this RFI are encouraged to be as succinct as possible, while also providing actionable insight. Format specifications for responses include 12-point font, single-spaced, single-sided, 8.5 by 11-inch paper, with 1-inch margins in Microsoft Word or Adobe PDF format.

To the maximum extent possible, respondents are encouraged to send non-proprietary information; if proprietary information is included, respondents are responsible for clearly identifying such information. Responses containing proprietary information must have each page containing such information clearly marked with a label such as “Proprietary” or “Company Proprietary.” DO NOT INCLUDE ANY CLASSIFIED INFORMATION IN THE RFI RESPONSE.

- A. Cover Sheet (1 page): Provide the following information
 - a. Response title,
 - b. Topic addressed (only one topic permitted per submission),
 - c. Technical point of contact name, organization, telephone number, and email address.
- B. Technical Description: 2 page maximum (1 succinct actionable page preferred). Respondents are strongly encouraged to consider DARPA’s mission to create radical new technological breakthroughs.
- C. Bibliography (not to exceed 2 pages): All references must be cited in the Technical Description.

Respondents may submit multiple responses, provided that each response addresses only a single topic area.

Responses that do not follow the instructions above will not be reviewed.

Industry leaders who employ best practices that may be outside the traditional DoD industrial base are encouraged to respond to this request. For those new to DARPA or national security, the agency offers comprehensive, free resources on how to do business with DARPA via DARPAConnect. Register for access via <https://www.darpaconnect.us/home>.

SUBMISSION INSTRUCTIONS AND CONTACT INFORMATION

All technical and administrative correspondence and questions regarding this RFI should be emailed to DARPA-SN-26-68@darpa.mil. Emails sent directly to the DARPA Program Manager may result in a delayed or no response.

All submitted questions must be held at the Unclassified, Distribution A level. Submitted questions that would result in a response higher than Distribution A will not be answered. Submitted questions will be accepted any time from the publication of this RFI until 5:00 PM ET on **May 4, 2026**. Responses to questions will be made available on **May 6, 2026**, and will be attached to this notice on sam.gov.

All responses to this RFI must be emailed to DARPA-SN-26-68@darpa.mil. Responses will be accepted any time from the publication of this RFI until 11:59PM ET on **May 8, 2026**. Early responses are highly encouraged.

TECHNICAL INTERCHANGE MEETING OBJECTIVE:

DARPA will host an in-person Technical Interchange Meeting (TIM) on Advanced Energetics Manufacturing to occur on **May 27**, in Arlington, VA. The purpose of this TIM is to meet with the energetics community to discuss technologies related to increasing the efficiency and/or

distributed production of energetic materials, promote additional discussion on this topic, address questions from industry and government stakeholders, and provide a forum for industry to present their capabilities.

TECHNICAL INTERCHANGE MEETING REGISTRATION

The TIM space is limited and only RFI respondents **WITH** approval from the hosting Program Manager via a formal invitation will be sent registration information for the event. RFI responses will be reviewed by leading experts in the advanced energetics manufacturing field from DARPA and U.S. Government partners to select attendees based on their RFI response/s. Invites will be selected on the basis of impact, innovation, and ensuring a diverse coverage of topic areas.

For Industry and University attendees, DARPA will respond from DARPA-SN-26-68@darpa.mil to submitted RFI responses at least **two weeks before the planned event in May 2026**. If invited, TIM registration details will be provided at that time.

For U.S. Government attendees, please email DARPA-SN-26-68@darpa.mil with your interest in attending and TIM registration details will be provided.

ELIGIBILITY

DARPA invites and appreciates responses from all those engaged in related research activities from all capable and qualified sources. The TIM will be reserved for U.S. Citizens only as discussions will be held at the Controlled Unclassified Information (CUI) level. No Green Card holders, U.S. Permanent Residents, or Foreign Nationals will be allowed to participate.

DISCLAIMERS AND IMPORTANT NOTES

- This is an RFI issued solely for information and research purposes; it does not constitute a formal solicitation for proposals. In accordance with FAR 15.201(e), responses to this RFI are not offers and cannot be accepted by the Government as such.
- Responses do not bind DARPA to any further actions related to this topic including requesting follow-on proposals from respondents to this RFI.
- Submission is voluntary and is not required to propose to a subsequent solicitation (if any) on this topic.
- DARPA will not provide reimbursement for costs incurred in responding to this RFI or participation in the TIM
- DARPA is under no obligation to acknowledge receipt of the information received or provide feedback to respondents with respect to any information submitted under this RFI.
- DARPA will disclose submission contents only for the purpose of review. Submissions may be reviewed by the Government (DARPA and U.S. Government partners) and Scientific, Engineering and Technical Assistance (SETA) support contractors.